



Man of the Hour

MANY HANDS WERE at work, but Telecom Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** was the driving force behind the timely launch of 5G in India. Apart from actively interacting with the industry, issuing letters within days of the spectrum auction and ensuring that the 5G service is affordably priced, he also allocated ₹26,000 crore to instal 25,000 new towers in the next 500 days. No wonder he was constantly in action at the four-day India Mobile Congress held between October 1 and 4.

—NIDHI SINGAL



EARLY BIRD

RELIANCE JIO MAY have entered the 4G race late, but this time around, for 5G, its new boss **Akash Ambani** is in no mood to give any quarter to competitors. With the launch of 5G services in four cities—Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata and Varanasi—on October 5, he has set an ambitious target of covering the entire country by December. Like Jio's popular 4G plans, he now aims to lure Indians with "very affordable" 5G packs. After all, the early bird catches the worm.

—ARNAB DUTTA

THE NEW-AGE SAMARITANS

A group of young start-up founders in India, led by Zerodha's **Nikhil Kamath**, is working to spread the giving culture in the country by pledging at least 25 per cent of their wealth to philanthropy. "We won't wait till 60; we will start giving away wealth in the 30s itself," Kamath said. Udaan Founder **Sujeet Kumar**, Curefoods Founder **Ankit Nagori** and Accel's **Prashanth Prakash**, among others, are part of the group, known as 'Young Indian Philanthropic Pledge'.

—BINU PAUL



"We won't wait till 60; we will start giving away wealth in the 30s itself," said Nikhil Kamath, Co-founder, Zerodha

STILL IN THE WOODS



SoftBank-backed OYO is reviving its plans for an IPO in early 2023, as a reduction in costs and a recovery in travel demand have helped the hospitality major trim its losses. The **Ritesh Agarwal**-led firm has cut down operations in the US and China, and is focusing on its core markets of India, Malaysia, Indonesia and Europe. It is hopeful that the festive season will drive more demand. Meanwhile, SoftBank has reduced the hospitality major's valuation. Hopefully, OYO's IPO plan will sail though this time.

—PRERNA LIDHOO

Picking Up the Gauntlet

Britannia Industries has named **Domino's India** executive **Rajneet Kohli** as its new CEO. Kohli joins at a time when the FMCG giant is looking to hike prices again to offset higher input costs, even as sales volume has taken a hit. In Q1FY23, its revenue grew 8.7 per cent year-on-year on the back of a 20 per cent price hike but volumes fell 2 per cent. Tough times ahead.

—VIDYA S.



Powering Ahead

Gautam Adani, Chairman of the Adani Group, has committed to investing \$100 billion in businesses such as green energy transition, digital opportunities, airports and ports, and logistics over the next 10 years. The group will invest 70 per cent of the amount in an integrated green hydrogen-based value chain. This will add another 45 GW to the group's existing 20-GW renewables portfolio. Adani, one of the world's 10 richest men, is on power mode.

—MANISH PANT

ASHWINI VAISHNAW AND RITESH AGARWAL PHOTOS BY YASIR IQBAL; NIKHIL KAMATH PHOTO BY SUDHIR DAMERLA